

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, FinTech & AI Platforms.*

Positioning, thirteen years owning regulated digital products, from a fintech acquisition to a defence-grade AI platform, distilled into one role.

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§ WHY ANTAL INTERNATIONAL

Government-affiliated entities in the Gulf face a problem most product managers never encounter: they must simultaneously satisfy regulators, sovereign policy objectives, international financial institutions, and end users, all at once, at scale. The posting names exactly that, translating regulatory and government requirements into secure, scalable, commercially viable digital products, and that intersection is where I have spent the majority of my career: a fintech P2P payment product taken to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem, an AI and data platform for a multinational defence programme, a national labour-market analytics platform serving federal policymakers, and a B2B insurance SaaS serving regulated underwriters. What draws me to Abu Dhabi specifically is the mandate to shape next-generation financial technology platforms at a foundational, policy-adjacent level, the kind of product surface where architectural decisions outlast any single roadmap. *That is precisely the environment where product rigour compounds into durable institutional value.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day assisted engineering review
- **Cursor** / **VSCode**, codebase navigation and prototyping
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy product surfaces

- **GPT**, requirement drafting and discovery synthesis
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
 - **Gamma.app**, executive-ready presentations
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, all carried through production delivery across defence, public-sector, insurance, and fintech contexts.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace eliminating the headhunter from construction staffing.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides of the market until commitment is reached.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents automate the full top-of-funnel.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one operator runs day-to-day operations.
 - Demonstrates the zero-to-one capability a PM needs when a government entity must build a net-new platform with no existing user base.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ANTAL INTERNATIONAL

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Meet each key stakeholder, government counterparts, technology leads, compliance officers, and external partners, and map the existing product landscape against the stated regulatory and policy requirements to find where the roadmap and governance model have the most unresolved risk.

WEEK 2

Triage and prioritise.

Run a structured prioritisation pass on the existing backlog, aligning each initiative to a KPI that the senior leadership team has already approved, and flag the two or three dependencies that will block delivery at scale if not resolved before the next planning cycle.

WEEK 3+

Ship, govern, expand.

Establish a cadence of regular executive reporting on delivery risks and release readiness, drive the first compliant product increment to launch, and begin mapping the roadmap toward regional and international expansion.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Product Manager position on Antal International's FinTech and AI Platforms search for a leading Abu Dhabi government-affiliated entity. The brief, translating government policy, regulatory requirements, and market needs into secure, scalable, compliant digital products, describes the shape of work I have been doing for thirteen years across fintech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, and regulated insurance platforms.

My closest match to the core of this role is the Payments and FinTech track. I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile group-based P2P Payments product, built it from zero, and took it to acquisition: it was acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem. That experience taught me what it means to ship a financial product inside a regulated infrastructure, where every design decision is also a compliance decision and where institutional partners need to trust the product before they will let it touch real money. I then spent five years as Co-Founder and Product Owner of Qcrypt AG, an IT security company delivering quantum-secure encryption to enterprise buyers, another domain where regulatory acceptance and security audit readiness are as much a product deliverable as the feature itself.

At the enterprise and government end of the spectrum, I led the AI and data Platform product at Rohde & Schwarz for the FCAS European defence programme, managing fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists across multinational teams. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes, and I redirected the entire product strategy after instrumented user-workflow analysis showed that a beautifully designed UI was recording exactly zero clicks. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I was Product Manager for the national labour-market analytics platform, where I also held the role of Deputy IT Security Officer. I migrated a bare-metal system into containers, introduced Dagster and dbt to reduce

data-update cycle time by seventy-five percent, and managed a full UI relaunch alongside an ETL migration, all within the governance constraints of a federal public-sector environment.

Across all of these roles the pattern has been the same: complex, multi-stakeholder products where the PM is the bridge between policy or strategy at the top and engineers, data scientists, compliance teams, and external vendors at the delivery layer. I am comfortable presenting to senior leadership and equally comfortable sitting with an engineering team to debug a release dependency. I have held budget responsibility as CFO and board chair, which means I bring a commercial lens to roadmap trade-offs as well as a delivery one.

Abu Dhabi is not a hypothetical relocation for me: it is a target I have been actively pursuing. I am ready to relocate and work fully on-site, and I see the GCC's ambition in fintech and digital government platforms as one of the most interesting product environments in the world right now. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background fits the specific platforms and stakeholder landscape you are building.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with thirteen years of product ownership in regulated digital environments, including FinTech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and Payments. Built and took a mobile P2P Payments product to acquisition inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem; led the AI and data Platform for the FCAS European defence programme; served as Deputy IT Security Officer on a federal analytics Platform. Equally at home presenting product strategy to executive and government audiences and resolving delivery dependencies with engineering teams.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

FinTech and Payments: P2P payment product design, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, regulated financial product delivery, payment flow and edge-case handling.

AI and Data Platforms: LLM agent design, agentic workflow orchestration, Explainable AI (XAI), AI governance, EU AI Act, ETL pipeline ownership, Dagster, dbt, data provenance and audit trails.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, KPI definition, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market.

Regulated Environments: GDPR (DSGVO), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, compliance-gated delivery, government and public-sector stakeholder management.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART planning, PI planning, Jira, Confluence.

Platform and DevOps Fluency: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Technical Stack: Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, SQL.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership (15+ engineers), C-level and executive reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes; redirected product strategy after instrumented workflow analysis lifted pipeline runs 200%; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum for the FCAS European programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS PLATFORM 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt to cut data-update cycle time by 75%; migrated bare-metal to containers; carried UI relaunch and ETL migration concurrently; Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023-2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed KPIs; user acceptance rose more than fivefold; shipped CGM hospital-information-system integration reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total to one departure; shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS
2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · SECURE GOVERNMENT
DATA PLATFORM 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B
PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and approximately 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · INDUSTRIAL IT MODERNISATION 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end for a wind-energy operator.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK
INFRASTRUCTURE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER AND EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace with anonymity-until-payment model, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based conversion analysis, built and operated alone.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware-software encryption product installable in under two minutes for enterprise buyers; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P Payments product from zero to acquisition; acquired by Sparkasse, operated inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · ANTAL INTERNATIONAL

